



COVER STORY: BATTLE FOR NUMBERS

SECURING THE FUTURE 18

By tying up with the Samajwadi Party, Sonia Gandhi is looking beyond the nuke deal to safeguard her political future which depends on how important a role she will get to play after the next elections



BUSINESS&ECONOMY: MICRO-FINANCE

The Next Billion 40

India's 1.7-crore financially excluded urban households attract innovative credit and savings products by micro-finance institutions and banks.

NEIGHBOURS: AFGHANISTAN



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Why Target India? 50

The suicide attack by the ISI-supported Taliban on the Embassy in Kabul is aimed at derailing India's reconstruction efforts in the country, which has earned it considerable goodwill.

BEIJING 2008: BOXING

The Boys from Bhiwani 54

INDIA TODAY begins its countdown to the 2008 Beijing Olympics with the remarkable story of how a nondescript Haryana town became India's boxing capital. It is a feat no other state can boast of.



VIKRAM SHARMA

SOCIETY&THE ARTS: CINEMA

Bubblegum Boys 60

Several young men have debuted recently, but the race to be the next It Boy continues.

INVESTIGATION: CBI

Dial C for CBI 44



With states not taking up police reforms and eagerly passing on cases to CBI, the agency has become a fire-fighting squad.

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Take a look at the latest job offers in the Market.

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